

Benjamin Abshire

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Education

Indiana University Bloomington

Expected May 2031

Ph.D. in Economics

Kent State University

May 2026

B.A. in Economics

B.A. in Mathematics

Relevant Coursework

Theory of Prices and Markets I (Doctoral), Macroeconomic Theory I (Doctoral & Masters), Econometrics I (Doctoral), Optimization Theory (Doctoral), Game Theory (Masters), Public Economics (Masters), Real Analysis I-II, Ordinary Differential Equations, Linear Algebra, Mathematical Optimization, Applied Statistics, Applied Econometrics I-II, Environmental Economics, Health Economics

Awards

Student Academic Appointment (Doctoral Assistantship), Recruitment Fellowship (Doctoral), President's List, Dean's List, Academic Achievement Award (Undergraduate Scholarship)

Experience

Teaching Assistant

August 2026 - Present

Department of Economics, Indiana University Bloomington

Held weekly office hours and graded homework for two sections of introductory undergraduate macroeconomics; revised quiz and exam questions for accuracy and proctored all exams.

Tutor

January 2024 - May 2026

Academic Success Center, Kent State University

Taught students various topics in Mathematics and Economics, including Calculus I-III, Algebra, Microeconomics, and Macroeconomics at both principle and intermediate levels.

Relevant Class Projects

Family Income and the Gap in Educational Attainment: Evidence from Higher Education

April 2026

Used PSID data and MLE regression methods to follow a cohort born from 1993-1997 to estimate the independent effect of family income on children's educational attainment.

The Strategy of Protectionism: Game Theory in International Trade

December 2025

Applied concepts from game theory to analyze the 2025 Trade War. Three games were considered, including an indefinite repeated prisoner's dilemma where both countries employ grim trigger and a game with alternating offers to model trade deals made by the U.S. and an Adversary.

The Effects of the 2018 Trade War on the Economy: A Review of the Literature

May 2025

Conducted an extensive review of 14 research papers on the effects of the 2018 Trade War on welfare, consumption, employment, trade reallocation, investment, imports, and exports.

Skills and Research Interests

Skills

Experience in SAS, R, Python, and $\text{\LaTeX}$

Research Interests

Poverty and Inequality, Social Welfare Programs, International Trade, Health, Environmental Economics